Aastha

Sydney, NSW | 0493547018 | aasthaaggarwal03@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/aggarwal-aastha |
Portfolio: https://aastha-aggarwal-portfolio.netlify.app/

Career Summary

Master of Commerce (Accounting and Finance) student at the University of Sydney (WAM 75%) with hands-on experience as an Accountant at DSV Partners, client-facing consulting projects, and a payments operations role at Saxo Group. Skilled in Xero, bank reconciliation, GST and income tax compliance, and clear client reporting. Seeking roles in audit and assurance, consulting, and risk management, where I can bring accuracy, data-backed advice, and strong stakeholder communication.

Education

Master of Commerce (Extension), Accounting and Finance **Feb 2026 – Dec 2027 (Expected)**
The University of Sydney Business School

- WAM: 75%; High Distinction in Responsible Business Mindset
- Peer Mentor Excellence Award, Semester 2, 2026

BBA (Hons.), Specialization in Finance – 7.53/8 **2021 – 2024**
O.P. Jindal Global University, India

Relevant Employment

Accountant **May 2026 – Oct 2026**
DSV Partners, Campsie, NSW

- Prepared almost 100 income tax and GST filings for individuals, companies, and partnerships.
- Flagged record errors before lodgement, reducing rework and compliance risk
- Prepared invoices and reconciled bank accounts in Xero
- Delivered month-end reports and resolved client queries within 24 hours

Consultant, Digital Industry Project **Sep 2026 – Present**
The University of Sydney Business School (client: The Food Granny, SA)

- Advised a small media business on sponsorship models, council grant criteria, and market rates
- Verified every data source and highlighted grant deadlines in the draft and final reports
- Led delegation by team strength and checked work against the rubric and deadlines.
- Presented a succinct case study in plain language; client feedback noted “sound, actionable pieces of advice” she had started to implement (11 October 2026).

Business Strategy Consultant **Jun 2026 – Jul 2026**
Ripponlea Laundry, Melbourne (student consulting project)

- Developed strategy recommendations to help a small local business scale
- Briefed the client directly on strategy recommendations and led progress meetings, translating complex analysis into clear, actionable guidance for a non-technical audience
- Authored a comprehensive, evidence-based business report rated High Quality against the program’s marking criteria; mentor feedback described the work as thorough and clear.
- Led the project team as Team Leader, keeping the group aligned and on track through an unexpected disruption and ensuring deadlines were still met.

Associate, Trade Operations (Payments) **Mar 2025 – Feb 2026**
Saxo Group, India

- Processed cross-border payments across SWIFT, SEPA, and ISO 20022 (PACS.008, MT/MX) rails, including FX processing
- Optimized straight-through processing (STP) workflows
- Applied data analysis to strengthen AML/KYC onboarding across 500+ client accounts, cutting discrepancies by 20% and manual processing time by 12%

FEMA Research **Nov 2023 – Apr 2024**

Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA)

- Researched the implications of FEMA for risk management in financial services, developing a framework to assess the impact of FEMA regulations on international transactions and contributing to policy recommendations for risk mitigation
- Collaborated with academic advisors and analyzed data trends and historical compliance issues to propose strategies for businesses to navigate FEMA regulations efficiently.

Intern **Jan 2023 – Feb 2023**

Motilal Oswal Financial Services, India

- Managed relationships with premium clients and provided tailored financial solutions, lifting client satisfaction by 30%
- Analysed market trends and client financial positions to support portfolio recommendations, with an average portfolio growth of 12%.
- Assisted with portfolio management and developed risk mitigation strategies from market analysis, reducing client portfolio risk by 15%

Summer Intern **Jun 2022 – Aug 2022**

Axis Bank, India

- Prepared reports and presentations on retail and corporate banking operations, supporting a 15% improvement in loan sanction processing
- Streamlined corporate banking processes, cutting approval times by 20%
- Built client presentations and reports that contributed to winning key accounts worth over ₹50 lakhs.
- Organized a client seminar with the Vice President, securing contracts worth ₹25 lakhs.
- Promoted company services and products through events, increasing client engagement by 20%

Leadership and Community Involvement

Lead Mentor (from next semester) and Peer Mentor **Semester 2, 2026**

Business School Peer Mentoring Program, University of Sydney

- Selected as the Peer Mentor Excellence Award recipient for Semester 2, 2026 (one mentor chosen per semester)
- Supported postgraduate students through the six-week program, welcome events, and engagement projects, helping them feel connected and informed.

Director, Business Development Committee **Aug 2026 – Present**

AIESEC in USYD

- Business development: connected companies with students so students build networks and companies find prospective candidates
- Client meetings: held face-to-face meetings and follow-ups with companies to explain what AIESEC offers, building rapport and learning how to prepare for client conversations.
- Presentation skills: presented AIESEC's needs clearly in front of clients.

V-Tutor **2026**

University of Sydney Union (USU)

- Peer learning support: provided learning support and built a peer-to-peer environment that sparked curiosity about new topics.
- Training: completed training modules on teaching concepts to students facing difficulties

Elected Member **Aug 2026 – Present**

Lions Club of Parramatta

- Helped raise $20,000 at the Ralph Hennes OAM Charity Golf Day for children with autism and cancer
- Supported community barbeques and events for local groups and nursing homes

Volunteer **Aug 2026 – Present**

SUPRA (Sydney University Postgraduate Representative Association)

- Support postgraduate student representation at the University of Sydney as a SUPRA volunteer.
- Assist with governance and administrative functions, including council records and communications, and volunteer engagement

- Contribute to initiatives that strengthen student representation, transparency, and community engagement across the University of Sydney.

Core Committee Member **Sept 2021–May 2024**
Student Committee, O.P. Jindal Global University

- Led planning and execution of student welcome fests and social events, managing volunteer rosters and task allocation across 20+ volunteers.
- Built organizational and cross-stakeholder communication skills by liaising with volunteers, faculty, and external parties simultaneously

Additional Volunteering and Case Competition Involvement **2026**

- Sydney Marathon (ASICS): volunteered at the event, guiding participants safely across road crossings, supporting hydration points, and encouraging runners, while networking with fellow volunteers
- Case study competition: applied consulting and audit-relevant frameworks, including stakeholder analysis, interest grid, root cause analysis, and RACI matrix, to develop and present recommendations on a live business case
- Exam time meal support: coordinated free meals for students during exam periods, liaising with professors and the volunteer team on planning and logistics
- Bushcare regeneration: participated in bushcare regeneration activities as part of a volunteer team, supporting local biodiversity and environmental preservation.

Skills

- **Technical:** Xero, bank reconciliation, GST and income tax preparation, month-end reporting, SWIFT, SEPA, ISO 20022, FX processing, AML/KYC, Microsoft Excel.
- **Transferable:** Client communication, built through advising a client in plain language and resolving queries within 24 hours at DSV Partners. Attention to detail, shown by flagging record errors before lodgement. Leadership and mentoring, shown through the Peer Mentoring Program.
- **Languages:** English, Hindi, Tamil

Short Courses/Certifications

Certificate in Investment Banking Operations Professional (CIBOP) **2024**
Imarticus Learning

- Gained a comprehensive understanding of the trade lifecycle, clearing and settlement, regulatory compliance frameworks, and operational risk management in investment banking.

Referees

Available upon request